

David vs. Goliath

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- But bananas are also grown in Caribbean countries, such as Jamaica and St. Lucia. In these countries, farms are smaller and are often run as family businesses. These small farms cannot achieve the same economies of scale as huge banana plantations. As a result, their costs are higher. To make money, they must sell their bananas at higher prices than the transnationals.



TNCS vs. Local

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Ecuador

Ecuador exports more bananas than any other country — and is the leading exporter of the bananas that are sold in North American supermarkets. If you ate a banana today, chances are that it grew in Ecuador. This is because bananas from Ecuador are cheap. Ecuadorean bananas are cheap because the cost of producing them is low.

One reason costs are low is that Ecuadorean banana workers are the lowest-paid in Latin America. In 2002, male banana-plantation workers earned about \$6.40 Cdn a day. Women were paid even less, and children were sometimes not paid at all. There was no overtime pay, and few workers received benefits, such as paid vacations and sick leave.

